

Fryer Oil Filtering & Change Schedule

Owner: Priya Nair (Sous Chef, Grill)

1) Scope and Purpose

- This SOP covers nightly fryer oil filtering, daily TPM testing, change triggers, par levels, and safety for the Grill station fryers.
- Goal: clean, consistent fry quality; safe, efficient operation; documented compliance.

2) Daily Schedule and Responsibilities

- Grill closer filters. Grill opener tests TPM. Either shift updates the fryer log and par count.

Tasks and limits:

Task	When	Limit / Trigger	Notes
Filter every fryer at close	Nightly	Use the built-in filter pump once oil is below 200°F	Wear face shield and oil-resistant gloves; use the oil caddy — do not carry open pots of hot oil.
Test total polar materials (TPM) with the Testo 270	Opening	Change at TPM reading $\geq 24\%$	Record in the fryer log.
Max days on oil	Ongoing	4 service days since the last change	Change earlier if TPM $\geq 24\%$ or quality degrades.
Visual/operational check	During service	Oil is dark, foams persistently, or smokes at 350°F	If any occur, change oil.

3) Tools, PPE, and Setup Checklist

- PPE: face shield, oil-resistant gloves, apron, closed-toe non-slip shoes.

- Tools: built-in filter pump, oil caddy with lid, fryer brush, skimmer/crumb scoop, filter screen and paper/basket that match the fryer, high-temp container for crumbs, Testo 270, clean towels.
- Staging:
 - Clear floor space. Post “Hot Oil” caution if guests can see back-of-house path.
 - Verify caddy is empty, valves closed, and wheels roll smoothly.
 - Confirm filter pan is assembled correctly (screen and paper seated; gaskets in place).

4) Nightly Filtering Procedure (Close)

1. Turn off fryer burners. Let oil cool until below 200°F.
2. Don face shield and oil-resistant gloves.
3. Skim large crumbs with a scoop. Do not splash oil.
4. Open the drain slowly into the filter pan. Keep the caddy/filter pan lid in place when moving oil. Use the oil caddy — do not carry open pots of hot oil.
5. Turn on the built-in filter pump. Circulate until the return oil runs clear and steady; move the return wand around the vat to sweep debris toward the drain.
6. Brush heating elements, corners, and the cold zone gently while filtering to dislodge sediment. Do not use water.
7. Close the drain. Return oil to the vat fully. Verify oil level. Top up with fresh oil if below the fill line.
8. Turn burners back on to standby temp as directed by the Sous Chef if needed, or leave off per close checklist.
9. Dispose of collected crumb waste in a designated solid waste bin when cool.
10. Break down the filter pan only if pressure is low or flow is weak; replace paper/screen as needed. Reassemble for the next use.

Safety

- Wear face shield and oil-resistant gloves. Never add water to hot oil. Use the oil caddy — do not carry open pots of hot oil.

5) Opening TPM Test With Testo 270

11. Power on the Testo 270. Ensure the probe is clean and dry.
12. Stir the fryer oil gently to get a representative sample.
13. Immerse the probe to the marked depth per device instructions. Avoid touching elements or the vat walls.
14. Hold steady until the reading stabilizes. Read and record in the fryer log for each fryer.
15. If the TPM reading is $\geq 24\%$, schedule an immediate oil change before service.

16. Wipe probe clean between vats. Store the meter dry.

Recording

- Note fryer ID, TPM %, oil age in service days, any visual issues (dark, foam, smoke at 350°F), and initials.

6) When to Change Oil

- TPM reading $\geq 24\%$, or
- 4 service days since the last change, or
- Oil is dark, foams persistently, or smokes at 350°F.

Change Procedure

17. Shut off burner. Allow oil to cool until below 200°F.
18. Move the oil caddy into place. Verify valves closed; lid ready.
19. Open the drain and capture oil into the caddy. Do not carry open pots of hot oil.
20. Close drain. Wipe spills immediately.
21. Refill vat with fresh canola frying oil to the fill line. Heat and verify normal operation.
22. Label the fryer log with the new start of service day count (Day 1).

7) Par Levels and Ordering

- Keep 4 cases (35 lb each) of canola frying oil on hand. At 2 cases or fewer, tell the Sous Chef so an order can be drafted.

Par quick guide:

On-hand cases	Action
4	At par.
3	Monitor; plan next order window.
2 or fewer	Tell the Sous Chef so an order can be drafted.

8) Troubleshooting and What-To-Do-If

- Filter pump not pulling:
 - Check that the drain is open and return valve is correct.
 - Power cycle the pump. Inspect for clogged screen/paper; replace if loaded with crumbs.
 - If still weak, stop, let oil settle, and notify Priya Nair or the Sous Chef on duty.

- Persistent foaming:
 - Change oil. Check for water/ice contamination from product. Dry product before frying.
- Smoking at 350°F:
 - Change oil immediately. Verify thermostat accuracy after refill if smoke persists.
- Erratic TPM readings:
 - Clean and dry the probe. Re-test. If still erratic, compare across vats; replace oil if near 24%. Report meter issues.
- Leaks/spills:
 - Kill burners. Contain with absorbent. Once cool, clean with degreaser. Log and report.

9) Quality and Safety Standards

- Product cues for spent oil: flat color on fries, bitter notes, rapid browning, sticky basket residue.
- Never add water to hot oil. Keep moisture away from vats.
- Maintain clear floors and dry paths when moving the oil caddy.
- Log everything: nightly filter done, TPM results, oil changes, and par checks. Consistent records back up food quality and safety.